

The Push for Interdisciplinary Efforts

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Coeckelbergh talked briefly about different forms of interdisciplinary research and how they are currently being used today and why they should be expanded. For starters, Coeckelbergh notes thinking of Philosophy as Performance, which provided a new way of framing Philosophy as a subject. Essentially, this way of framing philosophy as a field of study allows to create a bridge between the mental sciences and the physical or embodied sciences. Coeckelbergh also introduced the way of viewing technology as a choreographer of human thought and action. Specifically, Coeckelbergh says that “Technologies can be persuasive... they shape our attitudes and behaviours” (Coeckelbergh, p. 138).

Franchi takes a deep dive into different models of two disciplines interacting with each other. Franchi divides these interactions by the takeover model and the cooperative-agnostic model. For Franchi, “the takeover extreme is characterized by the minimum possible interaction between the disciplines. By increasing the level of reciprocal interaction... we move increasingly away from this end of the spectrum” (Franchi, p. 353). In other words, the takeover model acts as disciplines only using the other as necessary and there really isn’t much interdisciplinary work despite the two disciplines interacting. Franchi believes that AI emerged as a result for the computer scientists performing a takeover of philosophy and the humanities. On the other hand, Franchi also believes that the Digital Humanities is also a result of the humanities researchers taking over the computer sciences. Both these examples the disciplines only use the other as necessary as opposed to a truly interdisciplinary and integrative approach.

On the other hand, the cooperative-agnostic model would manifest itself in something like digital art, where the artists and the computer scientists cooperate hand in hand to create something new. Franchi states that In some cases, however, the encounters between artists and computational technology show the possibility of a different paradigm. This happens when making music, painting, producing installations, and writing with a computer changes the concepts artists work with, and, at the same time, forces computing disciplines to change theirs as well” (Franchi, p. 354). More specifically, Franchi gave examples of how musical theorists and sound theorists synthesized their knowledge to create musical pieces that were centered around the composition of tiny “sound grains” and the decomposition of whole sounds.

Both authors are pushing for the shift to a more interdisciplinary approach to the disciplines. For Coeckelbergh that takes places in pushing for a more performative philosophy. For Franchi, the push is towards the cooperative-agnostic model and away from the takeover model.

Works Cited

Coeckelbergh, Mark. "Thinking With Technology: How Machines Stage Our Thinking." In *Moved by Machines: Performance Metaphors and Philosophy of Technology*. Manuscript.

Franchi, Stefano. "The Past, Present, and Future Encounters between Computation and the Humanities." In *Philosophy and Theory of Artificial Intelligence*, edited by V.C. Müller, 349–64. Berlin: Springer, 2013.